on height and weight. In a large scale study like crop estimation, data are collected by estimation and using the powerful sampling techniques, because the actual counting may or may not be possible. Even if it is possible, the measurements involve more time and cost. The estimated figures may not be accurate and precise. However certain degree of accuracy has to be maintained for a meaningful analysis.

(5) To be placed in relation to the other.

One of the main reasons for the collection of statistical data is for comparisons In order to make meaningful and valid comparisons, the data should be on the same characteristic as far as possible. For instance, we can compare the monthly savings of male employees to that of the female employees in a company. It is meaningless if we compare the heights of 20 year-old boys to the heights 20 year- old trees in a forest.

Having looked into various definitions given by different authors to the term statistics in different contexts it would be appropriate to define

"Statistics in the sense of data are numerical statements of facts capable of analysis and interpretation".

"Statistics in the sense of science is the study of principles and methods used in the collection, presentation, analysis and interpretation of numerical data in any sphere of enquiry".

1.3 Functions of Statistics

The functions of statistics can be elegantly expressed as 7 - C's as :

S.NO	Functions	What it does
1	Collection	The basic ingredient of statistics is data. It should be carefully and scientifically collected
2	Classification	The collected data is grouped based on similarities so that large and complex data are in understandable form.
3	Condensation	The data is summarized, precisely without losing information to do further statistical analysis.
4	Comparison	It helps to identify the best one and checking for the homogeneity of groups,
5	Correlation	It enables to find the relationship among the variables
6	Causation.	To evaluate the impact of independent variables on the dependent variables.
7	Chance	Statistics helps make correct decisions under uncertainty.

Ch1_11th Stats.indd 5 2/3/2019 10:56:29 AM